

Names with a story

Etymology, phonetics & a little imagination

Alla 260 namn i dina 52 carousels, med engelska texter att använda i inläggen. Titlar, musik, publiceringsordning och delningsfrågor finns samlade här.

ETYMOLOGY

Namnshistoria och språkliga rötter. Osäkra betydelser markeras som osäkra. För namn med flera ursprung visas en vald tradition och ibland alternativa rötter.

PRONUNCIATION

Alla 260 namn har ett lättläst uttal inom [hakparenteser]. VERSALER markerar den betonade delen. Språket före hakparentesen visar vilken variant som avses, till exempel Italian: [ah-LESS-yo].

LANGUAGE VARIANTS

Ett namn kan sägas på flera sätt i olika språk och dialekter. Uttalsguiden visar en utvald variant per namn. Hakparenteserna ger en ungefärlig ljudbild och fångar inte alltid franska nasaler, arabiska konsonanter eller kinesiska toner. För Xia anges två toner.

STORY PHRASE

Den engelska frasen är kreativ copy som passar temat. Den beskriver en tänkt karaktär och är inte namnets betydelse eller ett påstående om en verklig persons personlighet.

SOURCES

Klickbara källor finns under varje namn. Behind the Name är huvudkälla; grundnamn och kompletterande uttalsreferenser länkas där det behövs. Uppslagsverk och ordböcker används för särskilda fall.

Publiceringsordning

En föreslagen testordning, ingen garanti för räckvidd. Börja med starka scener, varva tjej- och killnamn och justera efter delningar, sparningar och räckvidd. Till exempel två inlägg i veckan.

01 V Boy	for an Italian Villa	27 D Boy	for a Storybook Hero
02 A Girl	for a Villa by the Sea	28 P Girl	for a Painter's Daughter
03 B Boy	for a Childhood in the Countryside	29 O Boy	with a Gentle Wit
04 E Girl	for a Grandmother's Jewellery Box	30 N Girl	for a Moonlit Bedtime Story
05 L Boy	for a Summer in Italy	31 I Boy	for an Ancient Story
06 C Girl	for an Apartment in Paris	32 D Girl	for a Mythical Garden
07 A Boy	for Little Globetrotters	33 W Boy	for an English Storybook
08 B Girl	for a House with Painted Doors	34 O Girl	for an Opera-House Story
09 S Boy	That Feel Like Salt & Sun	35 J Boy	for a Pocket Full of Treasures
10 V Girl	for a Beautifully Bold Life	36 W Girl	for an English Cottage Garden
11 F Boy	for a Little Explorer	37 T Boy	for an Ancient Adventure
12 G Girl	for an Italian Summer	38 K Girl	for a Nordic Storybook
13 H Boy	That Feel Like Home	39 U Boy	with a Quiet Surprise
14 M Girl	That Feel Like Sunday Lunch	40 T Girl	with a Wild Imagination
15 P Boy	for a Mediterranean Summer	41 G Boy	with Old-Soul Charm
16 L Girl	for an Italian Love Letter	42 J Girl	with a Little Magic
17 N Boy	That Feel Like Sea Air	43 X Boy	for a Globe-Trotting Story
18 S Girl	for a Long Summer Evening	44 Y Girl	for a Journey Around the World
19 M Boy	for the Family Photo Album	45 Y Boy	with Stories from Everywhere
20 F Girl	for a Cottage Garden	46 U Girl	for a Free Spirit
21 C Boy	with a Dash of Drama	47 Q Boy	for the Curious
22 R Girl	for a Rose-Filled Garden	48 X Girl	with a Fearless Spirit
23 R Boy	with a Romantic Streak	49 Z Girl	with a Spark of Mischief
24 H Girl	Secret Garden Story	50 K Boy	with a Mischievous Spark
25 E Boy	That Feel Like Sunshine	51 Q Girl	for the Curious
26 I Girl	for a Woodland Fairytale	52 Z Boy	for a Grand Entrance

A 5 Girl Names for a Villa by the Sea

MUSIC Mystery of Love - Sufjan Stevens

Alma

Spanish: [AL-ma]

Probably Latin almus, meaning nourishing. The Spanish word alma means soul, an additional association. Someone whose warmth stays with you long after you have said goodbye.

Name source

Amara

English approximation: [ah-MAR-ah]

In Igbo, Amara means grace. This is the Igbo origin; other traditions use the same spelling. Someone who makes being loved feel simple, generous and without conditions.

Name source Pronunciation reference

Alba

Italian: [AL-ba]

Italian and Spanish alba means dawn; this can inspire the name. Older Latin and Germanic origins also exist.

Someone who sees each new beginning as a reason to hope.

Name source

Astrid

Swedish: [AS-strid]

From Old Norse Ástríðr, combining a word for god with a word for beautiful or beloved.

Someone who trusts their own path while making room for yours.

Name source Root source

Adèle

French: [ah-DEL]

French form of Adela, from the Germanic element adal, meaning noble.

Someone whose gentle heart gives even the smallest feelings a place to belong.

Name source Root source

A 5 Boy Names for Little Globetrotters

MUSIC Nantes - Beirut

Alessio

Italian: [a'lessjo]

Italian form of Alexius, ultimately from Greek alexo, meaning to defend or help.

Someone whose quiet strength makes others feel safe enough to be themselves.

Name source Root source

August

English: ['ɔ:gəst]

From Latin Augustus, a title expressing reverence or exalted status; related to augeo, to increase.

Someone who sees the good in others and gives it room to grow.

Name source Root source

Amir

Arabic: [ʔa'mi:r]

Arabic amir means prince or commander; it began as a title.

Someone who makes others feel they belong, wherever they come from.

Name source

Atlas

English: ['ætɫəs]

Greek mythological name, possibly connected with tlao, to endure. The derivation is uncertain.

Someone with the courage to meet the unfamiliar and the tenderness to understand it.

Name source

Arthur

British English: ['ɑ:θə]

Origin disputed: possible Celtic bear elements or the Roman family name Artorius. No single meaning is established.

Someone who notices what others feel, even when they cannot find the words.

Name source

B 5 Girl Names for a House with Painted Doors

MUSIC Les jours tristes - Yann Tiersen

Beatrice

Italian: [beh-ah-TREE-cheh]

Italian form of Beatrix, probably from Viatrix, traveller. Its spelling was influenced by Latin beatus, blessed.

Someone whose happiness grows when there is someone to share it with.

Name source Root source

Bianca

Italian: [BYAHN-ka]

Italian form of Blanche, meaning white or fair; ultimately related to a Germanic colour word.

Someone whose open heart makes others feel welcome just as they are.

Name source Root source

Bonnie

British English: [BON-ee]

From Scots bonnie, meaning pretty, ultimately related to French bon, good.

Someone whose playful warmth brings out the lightness in other people.

Name source

Bruna

Italian: [BROO-na]

Feminine of Bruno, whose Germanic root may refer to brown or to armour. The origin is debated.

Someone who feels deeply and loves with a steady, unhurried heart.

Name source Root source

Billie

English: [BIL-ee]

A familiar form of Bill and a feminine form of William, with Germanic roots for will and protection.

Someone who is wonderfully themselves and helps others feel free to be, too.

Name source Root source

B 5 Boy Names for a Childhood in the Countryside

MUSIC Bloom - The Paper Kites

Bruno

Italian: [BROO-no]

Germanic name with disputed roots: brown is one possibility; armour or protection is another.

Someone whose strength is gentle and whose affection is wholehearted.

Name source

Benjamin

English: [BEN-juh-min]

Hebrew name combining son and right hand; the latter can also refer to the south.

Someone who offers reassurance without making anyone feel small.

Name source

Basil

English: [BAZ-uhl]

From Greek Basileios, based on basileus, king; its sense is royal.

Someone whose imagination is bold and whose heart is generous.

Name source

Björn

Swedish: [BYURN (ö-sound)]

Scandinavian name from Old Norse björn, meaning bear.

Someone who is brave enough to be tender and steady enough to be trusted.

Name source

Bodhi

English: [BOH-dee]

From Sanskrit bodhi, awakening or enlightenment, a central concept in Buddhism.

Someone who pays attention with patience, curiosity and an open heart.

Name source

C 5 Girl Names for an Apartment in Paris

MUSIC Quelqu'un m'a dit - Carla Bruni

Celeste

English: [suh-LEST]

From Latin Caelestis, relating to heaven or the sky; based on caelum.

Someone whose quiet wonder makes the world feel a little more beautiful.

Name source Root source

Clara

French: [klah-RAH]

Feminine of Latin Clarus, with senses including bright, clear and renowned.

Someone who brings clarity with kindness and honesty with care.

Name source

Camille

French: [kah-MEEY]

French form of Camilla and Camillus, probably from an Etruscan name of unknown meaning. The popular ritual-attendant derivation is doubtful.

Someone who is curious about people and gentle with what they discover.

Name source Root source

Cora

English: [KOR-uh]

Latinized form of Greek Kore, meaning maiden, an epithet of Persephone.

Someone whose affection is sincere and whose joy is easy to share.

Name source

Chiara

Italian: [KYAH-rah]

Italian form of Clara, from Latin clarus, clear or bright.

Someone whose warmth helps others see themselves in a kinder light.

Name source Root source

C 5 Boy Names with a Dash of Drama

MUSIC La Valse d'Amélie - Yann Tiersen

Cosimo

Italian: [KO-zee-mo]

Italian form of Cosmas, from Greek kosmos, order, arrangement or adornment.

Someone whose expressive spirit gives every feeling room to be heard.

Name source Root source

Caspian

English: [KAS-pee-uhn]

Literary name taken from the Caspian Sea, famously used by C. S. Lewis; a geographical origin.

Someone who meets possibility with wonder and other people with openness.

Name source

Cillian

English approximation of Irish name: [KIL-ee-uhn]

Irish name, probably from cell, church, with a diminutive ending. The etymology is not certain.

Someone with a thoughtful heart and a quietly mischievous sense of humour.

Name source Pronunciation reference

César

French: [seh-ZAR]

French and Spanish form of Caesar, a Roman family name whose meaning remains uncertain.

Someone whose confidence makes room for others to feel confident, too.

Name source

Conrad

British English: [KON-rad]

From Germanic elements for brave and counsel, traditionally interpreted as brave counsel.

Someone who brings a calm heart and good judgment to uncertain moments.

Name source

D 5 Girl Names for a Mythical Garden

MUSIC Le jardin féerique - Maurice Ravel

Daphne

English: [DAF-nee]

From Greek daphne, laurel; also the name of a nymph in Greek mythology.

Someone whose tenderness grows alongside a strong sense of who they are.

Name source

Dahlia

English: [DAL-yuh]

From the flower, named after Swedish botanist Anders Dahl; the surname supplies the plant's name.

Someone who sees beauty in difference and never asks others to be smaller.

Name source

Daria

Italian: [DAH-ryah]

Feminine of Darius, from an Old Persian name expressing possession of goodness.

Someone who holds on to what is good, even when hope takes a little courage.

Name source Root source

Delia

Italian: [DEL-yah]

Greek epithet meaning of Delos, the island associated with the birth of Artemis and Apollo.

Someone whose gentle nature leaves room for wonder and for other people.

Name source

Désirée

French: [deh-zee-REH]

French feminine name meaning desired, from the past participle of désirer, to desire.

Someone who loves wholeheartedly and makes others feel truly wanted.

Name source

D 5 Boy Names for a Storybook Hero

MUSIC Concerning Hobbits - Howard Shore

Dante

Italian: [DAH-neh]

Short form of Italian Durante, from Latin Durans, enduring.

Someone whose courage comes from caring deeply about what matters.

Name source Root source

David

Swedish: [DAH-vid]

Hebrew name probably meaning beloved; an alternative connection with uncle has been proposed.

Someone whose loyalty makes love feel dependable and friendship feel safe.

Name source

Dorian

English: [DOR-ee-uhn]

Created for Oscar Wilde's novel; possibly inspired by the ancient Greek Dorians. The intention is uncertain.

Someone with a rich inner world and a tenderness that takes time to know.

Name source

Diego

Spanish: [DYEH-gho]

Spanish name of debated origin: possibly linked to Santiago or to Greek Didache, teaching.

Someone who welcomes change with curiosity and meets uncertainty with hope.

Name source

Darius

English: [duh-RYE-uhs]

From Old Persian Darayavahush, combining holding or possessing with good.

Someone who is thoughtful with their promises and generous with their trust.

Name source

E 5 Girl Names for a Grandmother's Jewellery Box

MUSIC La Vie en rose - Édith Piaf

Elsa

English: [EL-suh]

Short form of Elisabeth, ultimately Hebrew, commonly interpreted as my God is an oath.

Someone whose quiet loyalty makes others feel remembered and cherished.

Name source Root source

Elodie

French: [eh-loh-DEE]

French Élodie comes from Alodia, possibly Gothic elements for all or other plus wealth. The derivation is uncertain.

Someone with a gentle imagination and a warmth that is entirely their own.

Name source Root source

Esther

British English: [ES-tuh]

Origin uncertain: possibly Persian star or connected with the goddess Ishtar.

Someone whose courage shines softly, without needing to outshine anyone.

Name source

Esmé

English: [EZ-may]

From Old French esmé, esteemed or loved, the past participle of esmer.

Someone who makes others feel precious without asking them to be perfect.

Name source

Eira

Welsh: [EH-y-rah]

This Welsh origin comes from eira, snow. A separate Scandinavian origin also exists.

Someone whose calm presence gives busy hearts a little room to breathe.

Name source

E 5 Boy Names That Feel Like Sunshine

MUSIC Here Comes the Sun - The Beatles

Emilio

Italian: [eh-MEEL-yo]

Italian and Spanish form of Aemilius; associated with Latin aemulus, rival or one who strives to equal.

Someone whose warmth makes difficult days feel a little less lonely.

Name source Root source

Elias

English: [eh-LYE-uhs]

Form of Elijah, from Hebrew Eliyahu, expressing my God is Yahweh.

Someone who holds on to hope and helps others find their way back to it.

Name source Root source

Enzo

Italian: [EN-tso]

Italian name of uncertain origin, possibly from Heinz or Anzo; also a short form of Lorenzo or Vincenzo.

Someone whose joy is wholehearted and whose affection has no pretence.

Name source

Emil

Swedish: [EH-mil]

From the Roman family name Aemilius, traditionally linked to Latin aemulus, rival.

Someone who is easy to laugh with and gentle when laughter is harder to find.

Name source

Ezra

English: [EZ-ruh]

Hebrew name derived from a word for help.

Someone who offers kindness freely and understands when words are not enough.

Name source

F 5 Girl Names for a Cottage Garden

MUSIC Comptine d'un autre été : L'après-midi - Yann Tiersen

Flora

English: [FLOR-uh]

Derived from Latin flos, flower; also the name of the Roman goddess of flowers and spring.

Someone who nurtures what is good in others without rushing their growth.

Name source

Francesca

Italian: [frah-CHES-ka]

Italian feminine form of Francis, from Latin Franciscus, Frenchman; ultimately referring to the Franks.

Someone whose love feels generous, familiar and full of life.

Name source Root source

Freya

English: [FRAY-uh]

From Old Norse Freyja, lady, the name of a Norse goddess.

Someone who is independent in spirit and deeply considerate at heart.

Name source

Felicia

Italian: [feh-LEE-cha]

Feminine name related to Latin felix, fortunate or successful.

Someone who welcomes happiness without overlooking another person's sadness.

Name source Root source

Fern

American English: [FURN]

English nature name from the plant, continuing Old English fearn.

Someone whose quiet attentiveness makes overlooked people feel seen.

Name source

F 5 Boy Names for a Little Explorer

MUSIC Postcards from Italy - Beirut

Felix

English: [FEE-lics]

Latin personal name with the sense fortunate, successful or happy.

Someone who expects good things and brings a little hope to those around them.

Name source

Florian

French: [flor-YAHN]

From Roman Florianus, related to Florus and Latin flos, flower.

Someone whose curiosity is tender and whose wonder never feels hurried.

Name source Root source

Frans

Dutch: [FRAHNS]

A form of Francis, from Latin Franciscus, referring to a Frenchman.

Someone who would rather understand another person than be the cleverest voice.

Name source Root source

Finn

English: [FIN]

Irish Finn, related to Fionn, from a word for white or fair. A separate Scandinavian origin exists.

Someone who is adventurous in spirit and openhearted with people.

Name source Root source

Federico

Italian: [feh-deh-REE-ko]

Italian form of Frederick, combining Germanic elements for peace and ruler.

Someone whose calm confidence helps others feel brave enough to begin.

Name source Root source

G 5 Girl Names for an Italian Summer

MUSIC Sapore di sale - Gino Paoli

Greta

Italian: [GREH-ta]

Short form of Margareta and related names, ultimately from Greek margarites, pearl.

Someone who knows their own mind and remains curious about yours.

Name source Root source

Gaia

Italian: [GAH-yah]

From Greek gaia, earth, the name of the personified earth in mythology.

Someone who feels deeply connected to the world and cares for it with tenderness.

Name source

Giulia

Italian: [JOO-lyah]

Italian feminine form of Julius, a Roman family name with a disputed etymology.

Someone whose lively spirit is matched by a generous, welcoming heart.

Name source Root source

Gabriella

Italian: [gah-bree-EL-la]

Italian feminine of Gabriel, with Hebrew roots for strong man and God.

Someone whose strength gives others courage without taking away their voice.

Name source Root source

Giselle

French: [zhee-ZEL]

From a Germanic element meaning pledge or hostage, through medieval French forms.

Someone who brings grace to difficult feelings and warmth to quiet moments.

Name source

G 5 Boy Names with Old-Soul Charm

MUSIC The Book of Love - Peter Gabriel

Gabriel

Swedish: [GAH-bree-el]

Hebrew name combining gever, strong man, and el, God; traditionally rendered God is my strength.

Someone who understands that strength can be patient, gentle and kind.

Name source

Giovanni

Italian: [jo-VAHN-nee]

Italian form of John, ultimately Hebrew Yohanan, expressing Yahweh is gracious.

Someone whose affection feels enduring and whose loyalty is freely given.

Name source Root source

Gideon

English: [GID-ee-uhn]

Hebrew name derived from a verb meaning to cut down; often interpreted as a hewer.

Someone who faces difficulty with courage and other people with compassion.

Name source

Gustav

Swedish: [GUS-tav]

Etymology uncertain: possibly a combination referring to the Geats and a staff, or linked to Slavic Gostislav.

Someone whose patience makes others feel their thoughts are worth hearing.

Name source

Gaspard

French: [gahs-PAR]

French form of Jasper, possibly ultimately from a Persian word referring to a treasurer.

Someone who values trust deeply and treats another person's heart with care.

Name source Root source

H 5 Girl Names for the Main Character in a Secret Garden Story

MUSIC Le Moulin - Yann Tiersen

Hedda

Swedish: [HED-ah]

Scandinavian short form of Hedvig, from Germanic Hedwig, combining two elements for battle or war.

Someone who is quietly determined and curious about what lies beneath the surface.

Name source Root source

Helena

Swedish: [heh-LEH-nah]

Form of Greek Helene, probably related to torch; a connection with moon is another theory.

Someone whose warmth helps others feel hopeful without hiding what is hard.

Name source Root source

Harriet

English: [HAR-ee-et]

English feminine form related to Harry and Henry, from Germanic elements for home and ruler.

Someone who listens for the feelings beneath the words.

Name source Root source

Hana

Arabic: [hah-NAA]

In this Arabic tradition, Hana means happiness or bliss. The spelling has separate Japanese and European origins.

Someone whose happiness is generous enough to make room for everyone.

Name source

Hilda

English: [HIL-duh]

From Germanic hild, battle, used alone or as a shortened name element.

Someone who stands up for others with courage and stands beside them with care.

Name source Root source

H 5 Boy Names That Feel Like Home

MUSIC To Build a Home - The Cinematic Orchestra

Hugo

English: [HYOO-goh]

Germanic name from a root for mind, thought or spirit; related to Hugh.

Someone whose thoughtful nature makes understanding feel more important than judging.

Name source Root source

Henri

French: [ahn-REE]

French form of Henry, from Germanic elements meaning home and ruler.

Someone whose steady affection makes love feel like a place to rest.

Name source Root source

Hannes

Swedish: [HAN-ness]

Short form of Johannes, ultimately from Hebrew Yohanan, Yahweh is gracious.

Someone who makes belonging feel natural, without asking anyone to earn it.

Name source Root source

Hamza

Arabic: [HAM-zah]

Arabic name for a lion, connected with a word expressing strength or sturdiness.

Someone who carries strength lightly and treats vulnerability with tenderness.

Name source

Hector

British English: [HEK-tuh]

From Greek Hektor, connected with echo, to hold; commonly interpreted as holding fast.

Someone whose loyalty stays steady when another person needs it most.

Name source

I 5 Girl Names for a Woodland Fairytale

MUSIC Flightless Bird, American Mouth - Iron & Wine

Iris

English: [EYE-ris]

Greek iris means rainbow; the name belongs to the mythological messenger goddess as well as the flower.

Someone who sees possibility in difference and beauty in being fully yourself.

Name source

Ines

German: [EE-nes]

Form of Inés and Agnes, ultimately Greek hagnos, chaste or pure; not originally from the Latin word for lamb.

Someone whose sincerity makes trust feel easy and affection feel real.

Name source Root source

Ida

Swedish: [EE-dah]

Probably from Germanic id, work or labour. The early derivation is not entirely certain.

Someone who is quietly capable and patient with their own becoming.

Name source

Imani

Swahili approximation: [ee-MAH-nee]

Swahili imani means faith, borrowed from Arabic iman.

Someone who believes in others, especially while they are learning to believe in themselves.

Name source Pronunciation reference

Isolde

German: [ee-ZOL-duh]

Form of Iseult, with uncertain Celtic or Germanic roots; ice and battle is one proposed interpretation.

Someone with a tender heart, a vivid imagination and the courage to feel deeply.

Name source Root source

I 5 Boy Names for an Ancient Story

MUSIC M.A.Y. in the Backyard - Ryuichi Sakamoto

Isak

Swedish: [EE-sak]

Scandinavian form of Isaac, from Hebrew Yitshaq, he will laugh or rejoice.

Someone whose gentle humour makes others feel comfortable in their own skin.

Name source Root source

Idris

Arabic: [id-REES]

This Arabic name may relate to darasa, to study, with proposed senses of teacher or interpreter. The origin is uncertain.

Someone whose curiosity begins with a wish to understand.

Name source

Ivo

Italian: [EE-vo]

Germanic short name probably based on a word for yew; a Celtic origin has also been suggested.

Someone whose quiet wisdom leaves plenty of room for another point of view.

Name source

Ivan

Russian: [ih-VAHN]

Slavic form of John, ultimately from Hebrew Yohanan, Yahweh is gracious.

Someone whose love is steady and whose care reaches across differences.

Name source Root source

Ilias

Greek: [ee-LEE-ahs]

Modern Greek form of Elias, from Hebrew Elijah, my God is Yahweh.

Someone who finds meaning in connection and meets other people with sincerity.

Name source Root source

J 5 Girl Names with a Little Magic

MUSIC Once Upon a Dream - Lana Del Rey

Junia

Latin: [YOO-nee-ah]

Feminine form of Roman Junius, probably linked to Juno; the deeper origin is uncertain.

Someone whose hopeful heart makes possibility feel close enough to believe in.

Name source Root source

Josephine

English: [JOH-suh-feen]

Feminine form of Joseph, from Hebrew Yosef, he will add, with a traditional reference to God.

Someone whose generous spirit always has room for another person to belong.

Name source Root source

Juno

English: [JOO-noh]

Name of a Roman goddess; etymology uncertain, possibly connected with youth or an Etruscan source.

Someone who is confidently themselves and quietly protective of others.

Name source

Jasmine

English: [JAZ-min]

From the flower word, transmitted through French and Arabic from Persian yasamin.

Someone whose warmth is gentle, joyful and easy to feel at home with.

Name source

Judith

English: [JOO-dith]

Hebrew Yehudit means a woman from Judea; connected with Judah.

Someone who notices carefully and uses their understanding with kindness.

Name source

J 5 Boy Names for a Pocket Full of Treasures

MUSIC A Town with an Ocean View - Joe Hisaishi

Julian

English: [JOO-lee-uhn]

From Roman Julianus, derived from the family name Julius, whose deeper meaning is disputed.

Someone who holds people close without holding them back.

Name source Root source

Jasper

British English: [JAS-puh]

Possibly from a Persian title for a treasurer, transmitted through Hebrew; the derivation is not certain.

Someone who sees worth in others before they have learned to see it themselves.

Name source

Jonah

English: [JOH-nuh]

From Hebrew Yonah, meaning dove.

Someone who brings gentleness to disagreement and patience to friendship.

Name source

Jamie

Scottish [1]: [JAY-mee]

Scottish familiar form of James, related to Hebrew Jacob; the deeper meaning is debated.

Someone whose playful heart makes affection feel easy and friendship feel warm.

Name source Root source

Jude

English: [JOOD]

English form of Judas and Judah, probably from a Hebrew verb for praise.

Someone who is loyal in quiet ways and generous without needing recognition.

Name source Root source

K 5 Girl Names for a Nordic Storybook

MUSIC Riverside - Agnes Obel

Kerstin

Swedish: [SHER-stin]

Swedish form of Christina, from Latin Christianus, a follower of Christ.

Someone whose steady kindness makes uncertain moments feel less frightening.

Name source Root source

Klara

German: [KLAH-rah]

A spelling of Clara, from Latin clarus, bright, clear or renowned.

Someone whose honesty is clear and whose intentions are kind.

Name source Root source

Kaia

Norwegian approximation: [KYE-ah]

Scandinavian and Estonian short form of Katarina or Katariina. Their Greek etymology is disputed, later associated with purity.

Someone whose open spirit is rooted in a deep sense of belonging.

Name source Root source Pronunciation reference

Kira

Russian: [KEE-rah]

This Russian feminine form of Cyrus has an uncertain Persian origin; lord is one proposed meaning.

Someone who trusts their own voice and listens respectfully to others.

Name source Root source

Kalina

Polish: [kah-LEE-nah]

From the Slavic word kalina, referring to the viburnum plant.

Someone whose resilience is tender enough to leave room for joy.

Name source

K 5 Boy Names with a Mischievous Spark

MUSIC Young Folks - Peter Bjorn and John

Kasper

Swedish: [KAS-per]

Form of Jasper, possibly from an old Persian title referring to a treasurer.

Someone whose mischief is playful and whose heart is always on your side.

Name source

Karim

Arabic: [kah-REEM]

Arabic karim expresses generosity and nobility.

Someone who is generous with affection and gracious about other people's differences.

Name source

Kian

English approximation: [KEE-uhn]

Here the Irish-linked variant of Cian is used, meaning ancient or enduring. Persian Kian has a separate origin.

Someone whose curiosity is fearless and whose friendships are wholehearted.

Name source Root source Pronunciation reference

Konrad

German: [KON-raht]

Germanic name combining brave and counsel; a spelling variant of Conrad.

Someone whose quick wit comes with a thoughtful, considerate heart.

Name source Root source

Knut

Swedish: [KNOOT]

Scandinavian form of Old Norse Knútr, knot.

Someone who sees possibilities where others see limits, and shares that hope freely.

Name source

L 5 Girl Names for an Italian Love Letter

MUSIC Il cielo in una stanza - Mina

Leonora

Italian approximation: [leh-oh-NOH-rah]

Short form of Eleonora or Eleanor, ultimately from Occitan Alienòr. Its etymology is uncertain; light is not established.

Someone whose thoughtful affection makes others feel deeply understood.

Name source Root source Pronunciation reference

Lucia

Italian: [loo-CHEE-ah]

Feminine form of Lucius, traditionally connected with Latin lux, light.

Someone who brings warmth to uncertainty and helps others find their confidence.

Name source Root source

Liv

Swedish: [LEEV]

From Old Norse Hlíf, protection; its modern use also evokes the Scandinavian word for life.

Someone whose love is quietly expressed and deeply felt.

Name source

Livia

Italian: [LEE-vyah]

Feminine of the Roman family name Livius, possibly related to envy or a bluish colour. The derivation is uncertain.

Someone whose calm manner holds a lively, curious inner world.

Name source Root source

Leila

Arabic: [LAY-lah]

Variant of Arabic Layla, based on layl, night.

Someone who gives feelings time to unfold and people room to be themselves.

Name source Root source

L 5 Boy Names for a Summer in Italy

MUSIC Estate - Bruno Martino

Leone

Italian: [leh-OH-neh]

Italian form of Leo and Leon, from Latin and Greek words for lion.

Someone whose courage is generous and whose strength makes others feel safe.

Name source Root source

Luca

Italian: [LOO-kah]

Italian form of Lucas and Luke, originally referring to someone from Lucania in southern Italy.

Someone who meets life with openness and other people with easy warmth.

Name source Root source

Leon

British English: [LEE-on]

From Greek leon, meaning lion.

Someone who is brave in their own way and tender with the people they love.

Name source

Ludvig

Swedish: [LUD-vig]

Scandinavian form of Ludwig, with Germanic elements for fame and battle.

Someone whose lively confidence encourages others to trust themselves.

Name source Root source

Lorenzo

Italian: [loh-REN-tso]

Italian form of Laurentius, meaning from Laurentum, an ancient Italian town; associated with Latin laurus, laurel.

Someone who gives affection patiently and makes closeness feel unhurried.

Name source Root source

M 5 Girl Names That Feel Like Sunday Lunch

MUSIC Dream a Little Dream of Me - Ella Fitzgerald & Louis Armstrong

Matilda

English: [muh-TIL-duh]

Germanic name combining maht, strength, and hild, battle.

Someone whose quiet strength helps others feel supported without feeling managed.

[Name source](#)

Mira

Macedonian: [MEE-rah]

This Slavic short form comes from names with mir, peace or world. Other origins have separate meanings.

Someone who finds common ground while respecting what makes each person different.

[Name source](#)

Margot

French: [mar-GOH]

French short form of Marguerite, ultimately Greek margarites, pearl.

Someone whose warmth feels effortless and whose care is thoughtful.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#)

Malou

Danish approximation: [mah-LOO]

Blend or short form of Marie-Louise. Marie has disputed ancient roots; Louise derives from elements for fame and battle.

Someone who senses what others need and cares without taking over.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#) [Pronunciation reference](#)

Miriam

English: [MIR-ee-uhm]

Biblical Hebrew name of uncertain etymology, perhaps ultimately Egyptian and connected with love or beloved.

Someone whose love makes others feel known in all their little differences.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#)

M 5 Boy Names for the Family Photo Album

MUSIC First Day of My Life - Bright Eyes

Milo

English: [MY-loh]

Old German and Latinized form related to Miles, with uncertain origin; a connection with Slavic dear is proposed.

Someone whose playful tenderness makes it easy to be happy together.

Name source Root source

Matteo

Italian: [mah-TEH-oh]

Italian form of Matthew, from Hebrew Mattityahu, gift of Yahweh.

Someone who receives love openly and gives it back with a generous heart.

Name source Root source

Malik

Arabic: [MAH-lik]

This Arabic form means king. The similar transcription Maalik can instead refer to an owner or master.

Someone whose self-respect goes hand in hand with respect for others.

Name source

Morris

British English: [MOR-is]

English form of Maurice, from Latin Mauritius and Maurus, referring historically to someone from Mauretania.

Someone whose easy warmth makes friendship feel familiar from the beginning.

Name source Root source

Marcel

French: [mar-SEL]

French form of Marcellus, a diminutive of Marcus, perhaps connected with Mars; the root is uncertain.

Someone who makes people feel remembered, even across distance and time.

Name source Root source

N 5 Girl Names for a Moonlit Bedtime Story

MUSIC Gymnopédie No. 1 - Erik Satie

Noa

Spanish: [NOH-ah]

Hebrew Noa is a feminine biblical name meaning motion. It is distinct from masculine Noah, rest.

Someone whose curious heart welcomes change without losing its gentleness.

Name source Root source

Nora

English: [NOR-uh]

Short form of Honora, linked to Latin honour, or Eleanor, whose origin is uncertain. Arabic Nora is a separate tradition.

Someone who is quietly thoughtful and open to a world beyond their own.

Name source Root source

Nina

Italian: [NEE-na]

Often a short form of names ending in nina, such as Antonina or Giannina; it has no single universal meaning.

Someone whose affection is tender and whose imagination leaves room for wonder.

Name source

Nerea

Basque: [neh-REH-ah]

Basque name possibly based on nere, mine, or a feminine form of Greek Nereus. The derivation is uncertain.

Someone who values closeness while giving others the freedom to grow.

Name source

Naomi

English: [nay-OH-mee]

Hebrew name based on a root for pleasantness, traditionally interpreted as my pleasantness.

Someone whose reassuring warmth makes it safe to share a difficult feeling.

Name source

N 5 Boy Names That Feel Like Sea Air

MUSIC Sea of Love - Cat Power

Nico

Italian: [NEE-ko]

Short form of Nicholas, from Greek elements for victory and people.

Someone whose easy confidence leaves others free to find their own.

Name source Root source

Nils

Swedish: [NILS]

Scandinavian form of Nicholas, ultimately Greek, combining victory and people.

Someone who is quietly dependable and thoughtful about the feelings of others.

Name source Root source

Noah

English: [NOH-uh]

From Hebrew Noah, based on a verb for resting; distinct from the feminine name Noa.

Someone whose calm heart makes room for both closeness and independence.

Name source

Nadir

Arabic: [NAA-deer]

Arabic name from a word for rare or uncommon.

Someone who values what is different and makes others feel special as they are.

Name source

Nikolai

Russian: [nee-kah-LYE]

Form of Nicholas, from Greek nike, victory, and laos, people.

Someone whose adventurous spirit comes with a generous sense of companionship.

Name source Root source

O 5 Girl Names for an Opera-House Story

MUSIC O mio babbino caro - Maria Callas

Olivia

English: [oh-LIV-ee-ah]

Probably a Shakespearean elaboration related to Latin oliva, olive, or to Oliver. The exact formation is uncertain.

Someone whose imagination is expansive and whose welcome is wholehearted.

Name source

Otilia

Swedish: [oot-TEE-lee-ah]

Swedish form of Odilia, from Germanic elements for heritage or wealth.

Someone whose self-assurance is gentle and whose affection is lasting.

Name source Root source

Ophelia

English: [oh-FEEL-ee-ah]

From Greek opheleia, help or benefit; used in Renaissance literature and Shakespeare's Hamlet.

Someone who feels deeply and responds to other people's feelings with care.

Name source

Oona

English: [OO-nuh]

Anglicized spelling of Irish Úna, traditionally linked to uan, lamb.

Someone whose quiet sensitivity holds a wonderfully original view of the world.

Name source Root source

Odette

French: [oh-DET]

French diminutive of Oda, related to a Germanic element for wealth or fortune.

Someone whose grace comes from treating themselves and others with kindness.

Name source Root source

O 5 Boy Names with a Gentle Wit

MUSIC La Javanaise - Serge Gainsbourg

Oscar

Italian: [OS-kar]

Possibly Irish deer and friend; alternatively related to Germanic elements for god and spear. The origin is debated.

Someone whose humour brings people together and whose heart keeps them close.

Name source

Otis

English: [OH-tis]

From an English surname related to Ode and Otto, based on a Germanic word for wealth.

Someone whose easy manner makes it safe to be a little less guarded.

Name source

Omar

Arabic: [OO-mar]

A transcription of Arabic Umar, connected with life and expressing flourishing or long life.

Someone who meets other people's stories with interest and respect.

Name source Root source

Olle

Swedish: [OOL-leh]

Swedish familiar form of Olof or Oliver; the Olof branch has Old Norse roots for ancestor and inheritance.

Someone whose uncomplicated affection makes ordinary moments feel warm.

Name source Root source

Orlando

Italian: [or-LAHN-doh]

Italian form of Roland, usually linked to Germanic fame and land; the second element is debated.

Someone with a spirited imagination and a generous sense of humour.

Name source Root source

P 5 Girl Names for a Painter's Daughter

MUSIC La fille aux cheveux de lin - Claude Debussy

Paloma

Spanish: [pah-LOH-mah]

Spanish word for dove, used as a given name.

Someone who values peace without asking anyone to hide how they feel.

Name source

Petra

English: [PET-ruh]

Feminine of Peter, from Greek petros, stone or rock.

Someone whose steadiness offers comfort and whose kindness leaves room for change.

Name source Root source

Pia

Italian: [PEE-ah]

Feminine form of Latin Pius, expressing piety or devotion.

Someone whose sincerity makes even a small kindness feel meaningful.

Name source Root source

Penelope

English: [puh-NEL-uh-pee]

Greek name with uncertain roots: a word for duck or elements relating to thread and face have been proposed.

Someone whose patience comes from caring, and whose imagination keeps hope alive.

Name source

Pauline

French: [poh-LEEN]

French feminine form of Paulinus, derived from Latin Paulus, small or humble.

Someone who is gentle in their confidence and generous in their encouragement.

Name source Root source

P 5 Boy Names for a Mediterranean Summer

MUSIC Via con me - Paolo Conte

Pietro

Italian: [PYEH-troh]

Italian form of Peter, from Greek petros, stone or rock.

Someone whose dependable heart makes others feel supported in being themselves.

Name source Root source

Pascal

French: [pas-KAL]

From Latin Paschalis, relating to Easter, ultimately from the Hebrew word for Passover.

Someone who is thoughtful about change and hopeful about new beginnings.

Name source

Philip

English: [FIL-ip]

From Greek Philippos, combining philos, friend or lover, and hippos, horse.

Someone whose enthusiasm is welcoming and whose friendships are sincere.

Name source

Paolo

Italian: [PAH-oh-loh]

Italian form of Paul, from Latin Paulus, small or humble.

Someone whose modest confidence lets kindness speak for itself.

Name source Root source

Percy

British English: [PUR-see]

English surname from the Norman place Perci, with uncertain deeper roots; also a short form of Percival.

Someone whose playful curiosity makes others feel invited into the wonder.

Name source

Q 5 Girl Names for the Curious

MUSIC The Secret Life of Daydreams - Jean-Yves Thibaudet

Quinn

English: [KWIN]

From Irish Ó Cuinn, descendant of Conn; Conn may relate to sense or reason, or head or chief.

Someone who welcomes a different opinion and loves discovering a new perspective.

Name source Root source

Qamar

Arabic: [KAH-mar]

Arabic word for moon, used as a name for more than one gender.

Someone whose quiet warmth makes it easier to share what is in your heart.

Name source

Quilla

Quechua base killa: [KEE-lyah]

A Spanish-era spelling of Quechua killa, moon, associated with the Inca moon deity Mama Quilla. Personal-name usage is less securely documented.

Someone with a gentle imagination and an instinct for understanding others.

Name source Deity reference

Queenie

English: [KWEE-nee]

English affectionate formation from queen, with a diminutive ending.

Someone whose bright confidence celebrates the people around them.

Name source

Quintina

English approximation: [kwin-TEE-nah]

Feminine form of Quintinus, derived from Latin Quintus, fifth.

Someone who is quietly individual and openhearted about other people's differences.

Name source Root source Pronunciation reference

Q 5 Boy Names for the Curious

MUSIC Futile Devices (Doveman Remix) - Sufjan Stevens

Quentin

French: [kahn-TEHN]

French form of Roman Quintinus, derived from Latin Quintus, fifth.

Someone who asks thoughtful questions and gives the answers time to unfold.

Name source Root source

Quincy

English: [KWIN-see]

From a Norman place-derived surname, ultimately associated with the Roman name Quintus, fifth.

Someone whose curiosity is lively and whose company feels inclusive.

Name source Root source

Qasim

Arabic: [KAA-sim]

Arabic name connected with dividing or distributing; traditionally understood as a distributor.

Someone whose generous nature makes sharing feel joyful rather than dutiful.

Name source

Qadir

Arabic: [KAA-dir] / [kah-DEER] (two Arabic forms)

Arabic transcription of names meaning capable or powerful. Two Arabic forms have different vowel lengths and stress.

Someone who uses their confidence to encourage, never to diminish.

Name source

Quirin

German: [kvee-REEN]

German form of Quirinus, possibly from Sabine quiris, spear. The derivation is uncertain.

Someone whose independent mind is matched by a considerate heart.

Name source Root source

R 5 Girl Names for a Rose-Filled Garden

MUSIC *Que reste-t-il de nos amours ?* - Charles Trenet

Rosa

Italian: [ROH-zah]

Generally linked to Latin *rosa*, rose, though an older Germanic name may also have influenced its history.

Someone whose affection is wholehearted and whose tenderness has its own strength.

Name source

Runa

Swedish: [ROO-na]

Feminine form of *Rune*, from an Old Norse word for secret lore or a rune.

Someone who respects the parts of a person that take time to understand.

Name source Root source

Romy

French: [roh-MEE]

Familiar form of *Rosemarie*, *Rosemary* or other names beginning *Rom*; the meaning depends on the full name.

Someone whose playful warmth makes being together feel wonderfully easy.

Name source

Rania

Arabic: [RAH-nee-yah]

Arabic *Raniya*, possibly connected with *rana*, to gaze or look intently. The derivation is not certain.

Someone who carries confidence with grace and treats others as equals.

Name source Root source

Renée

French: [ruh-NEH]

French feminine form of *René*, from Latin *Renatus*, born again.

Someone who believes people can grow and welcomes them as they become themselves.

Name source Root source

R 5 Boy Names with a Romantic Streak

MUSIC La chanson des vieux amants - Jacques Brel

Rafael

Spanish: [rah-fah-EL]

Form of Raphael, from Hebrew elements for heal and God, expressing God has healed.

Someone whose gentle care helps others feel a little more whole.

Name source Root source

Romeo

Italian: [roh-MEH-oh]

Italian name connected with Roma, Rome, historically referring to a Roman or a pilgrim to Rome.

Someone who loves openly and has the courage to let that love be seen.

Name source

Ruben

Swedish: [ROO-ben]

Form of Reuben, from Hebrew elements traditionally interpreted as behold, a son.

Someone whose affection makes others feel noticed, valued and wanted.

Name source Root source

Rasmus

Swedish: [RAS-mus]

Short form of Erasmus, from Greek erasmios, beloved or desired.

Someone whose warmth is sincere and whose kindness asks for nothing in return.

Name source Root source

Rocco

Italian: [ROK-koh]

Germanic name of uncertain origin, possibly related to a word for crow or rook.

Someone whose loyalty is strong and whose gentleness is easy to trust.

Name source

S 5 Girl Names for a Long Summer Evening

MUSIC Je te laisserai des mots - Patrick Watson

Selma

English: [SEL-muh]

Meaning uncertain: possibly a short form of Anselma or inspired by Ossian's castle in Macpherson's poems. Turkish Selma has another origin.

Someone whose steady warmth makes space for everyone to feel at ease.

Name source

Sofia

Greek: [soh-FEE-ah]

Form of Sophia, from Greek sophia, wisdom.

Someone whose understanding is thoughtful and whose wisdom stays kind.

Name source Root source

Soleil

French: [soh-LAY]

French word for sun, used as a modern given name.

Someone whose bright spirit gives others permission to feel joy.

Name source

Signe

Swedish: [SING-neh]

Scandinavian form of Old Norse Signý, combining victory and new.

Someone who is sure of their values and gentle with another person's uncertainty.

Name source Root source

Soraya

Persian: [soh-rah-YAH]

Persian form of Arabic Thurayya, the name of the Pleiades star cluster.

Someone whose generosity makes others feel part of something beautiful.

Name source Root source

S 5 Boy Names That Feel Like Salt & Sun

MUSIC Sapore di sale - Gino Paoli

Silas

English: [SY-luhs]

Probably a shortened form related to Silvanus, from Latin *silva*, wood or forest; a connection with Saul is also proposed.

Someone whose quiet independence goes hand in hand with a caring heart.

Name source

Samuel

English: [SAM-yoo-uhl]

Hebrew name of disputed interpretation, often explained as name of God or God has heard.

Someone who listens with patience and makes others feel their voice matters.

Name source

Siro

Italian: [SEE-roh]

Italian form of Syrus, from Greek Syros, a person from Syria.

Someone whose lively spirit makes room for laughter, curiosity and affection.

Name source Root source

Sebastian

German: [zeh-BAS-tee-ahn]

From Greek Sebastianos, a person from Sebaste; the place name derives from *sebastos*, venerable.

Someone whose confidence is warm and whose consideration is sincere.

Name source

Sami

Arabic: [SAA-mee]

This Arabic form means elevated or sublime. Finnish Sami, a short form of Samuel, has a separate origin.

Someone who is open to the world and attentive to the person beside them.

Name source

T 5 Girl Names with a Wild Imagination

MUSIC Space Song - Beach House

Thea

German: [TAY-ah]

Short form of Dorothea, Theodora or Theresa; the first two relate to God's gift, while Theresa's origin is disputed.

Someone whose curiosity helps others see new possibilities in themselves.

Name source Root source

Tilda

English: [TIL-duh]

Short form of Matilda, from Germanic elements for strength and battle.

Someone whose bold imagination is held by a gentle, thoughtful heart.

Name source Root source

Thalia

English: [THAY-lee-ah]

Greek name based on thallo, to blossom or flourish; borne by a Muse and a Grace.

Someone whose joy gives others room to feel lighter and more fully themselves.

Name source

Tove

Swedish: [TOO-veh]

Scandinavian form of Tófa, a short form of Þórfríðr, combining Thor and beautiful.

Someone whose originality feels natural and whose warmth is quietly reassuring.

Name source

Teresa

Spanish: [teh-REH-sah]

Ancient name of uncertain origin; summer, harvest and the Greek island Therasia are proposed connections.

Someone who cares deeply while respecting another person's independence.

Name source Root source

T 5 Boy Names for an Ancient Adventure

MUSIC The Breaking of the Fellowship - Howard Shore

Teodoro

Italian: [teh-oh-DOH-roh]

Italian, Spanish and Portuguese form of Theodore, from Greek elements for God and gift.

Someone whose grateful heart makes love feel received as well as given.

Name source Root source

Theo

English: [THEE-oh]

Short form of Theodore or Theobald: the former has Greek God and gift roots; the latter Germanic people and bold.

Someone whose openness makes curiosity feel welcoming rather than demanding.

Name source Root source

Tristan

English: [TRIS-tuhn]

From Pictish Drustan, related to Drust, of uncertain meaning. French triste, sad, influenced the later spelling.

Someone who has the courage to feel deeply and the kindness to understand sorrow.

Name source Root source

Tobias

Swedish: [too-BEE-ahs]

From Hebrew Tobiah, combining good and Yahweh; traditionally understood as Yahweh is good.

Someone who trusts in goodness without expecting people to be perfect.

Name source Root source

Titus

Latin: [TEE-toos]

Roman personal name of uncertain origin, possibly related to Oscan Titus. A confident meaning is not established.

Someone whose determination is considerate and whose courage is quietly generous.

Name source

U 5 Girl Names for a Free Spirit

MUSIC Dreams - Fleetwood Mac

Uma

English approximation: [OO-mah]

Sanskrit name associated with flax and the goddess Parvati; Hindu tradition also offers an explanation through an exclamation.

Someone whose independence leaves room for closeness and whose curiosity feels free.

Name source Pronunciation reference

Una

English: [OO-nuh]

English form of Irish Úna, linked to lamb; also associated with Latin una, one. These are separate connections.

Someone who knows the value of belonging without losing what makes them individual.

Name source Root source

Ulrika

Swedish: [uul-REE-kah]

Swedish feminine of Ulrich, from Germanic elements for heritage and ruler.

Someone whose strong sense of self helps others feel secure in their own.

Name source Root source

Ulla

Finnish: [OOL-lah]

Scandinavian short form of Ulrika or Hulda; in German it can shorten Ursula. Meaning depends on the branch.

Someone whose quiet confidence is softened by a generous, affectionate nature.

Name source

Ursula

American English: [UR-suh-luh]

Latin diminutive of ursa, female bear, giving the sense little bear.

Someone whose protective heart knows when to offer comfort and when to give space.

Name source

U 5 Boy Names with a Quiet Surprise

MUSIC Germination - Ryuichi Sakamoto

Ugo

Italian: [OO-goh]

Italian form of Hugh, from a Germanic word for mind, thought or spirit.

Someone whose thoughtful silence holds curiosity, warmth and a little unexpected wit.

Name source Root source

Uno

Swedish approximation: [OO-noh (Swedish u)]

Scandinavian name of uncertain origin, possibly from Old Norse Uni or Latin unus, one.

Someone who is comfortable being different and makes others feel comfortable, too.

Name source Pronunciation reference

Umar

Arabic: [OO-mar]

Arabic name related to life, with a sense of flourishing or living long.

Someone whose steady hope leaves room for growth, forgiveness and new beginnings.

Name source

Ulrik

Swedish: [OOL-rik]

Scandinavian form of Ulrich, combining Germanic heritage and ruler.

Someone whose strength is measured by the care they give to others.

Name source Root source

Uriel

English: [YOOR-ee-uhl]

Hebrew name combining light or flame and God, interpreted as God is my light.

Someone whose insight brings understanding and whose kindness brings reassurance.

Name source

V 5 Girl Names for a Beautifully Bold Life

MUSIC La ritournelle - Sébastien Tellier

Viola

Italian: [VYOH-lah]

Latin word for violet, used as a name; also a Shakespearean character in Twelfth Night.

Someone whose sensitivity is a strength and whose imagination is entirely their own.

Name source

Vera

Swedish: [VEH-rah]

In the Russian tradition, Vera means faith; it is also associated with Latin verus, true.

Someone whose honesty feels safe because it is offered with tenderness.

Name source

Valentina

Italian: [vah-lehn-TEE-nah]

Feminine of Valentinus, derived from Latin Valens, strong or healthy.

Someone whose brave heart loves generously and feels without hesitation.

Name source Root source

Vesper

British English: [VES-puh]

Latin name or word for evening, connected with the personification of the evening star.

Someone whose quiet presence makes thoughtful moments feel companionable.

Name source Root source

Vivienne

French: [vee-VYEHN]

French feminine form ultimately from Latin Vivianus and vivus, alive.

Someone whose love of life makes others feel more alive, too.

Name source Root source

V 5 Boy Names for an Italian Villa

MUSIC L'appuntamento - Ornella Vanoni

Valerio

Italian: [vah-LEH-ryoh]

Italian form of the Roman family name Valerius, from Latin valeo, to be strong.

Someone who holds courage and compassion close together.

Name source Root source

Vincent

French: [van-SAHN]

From Latin Vincentius, based on vinco, to conquer.

Someone who celebrates other people's growth as warmly as their own.

Name source

Viktor

German: [VIK-tor]

A form of Latin Victor, victor or conqueror, used in many European languages.

Someone whose determination leaves room for fairness, patience and kindness.

Name source Root source

Valentino

Italian: [vah-lehn-TEE-noh]

Italian form of Valentinus, from Latin Valens, strong, vigorous or healthy.

Someone whose warmth is expressive and whose affection is wholehearted.

Name source Root source

Viggo

Swedish: [VIG-go]

Short form of names containing Old Norse vig, war or battle.

Someone who is spirited enough to be brave and thoughtful enough to be gentle.

Name source

W 5 Girl Names for an English Cottage Garden

MUSIC Moon River - Audrey Hepburn

Willa

English: [WIL-uh]

Feminine form of William, with Germanic elements for will and helmet or protection.

Someone whose quiet resolve is rooted in care for the people they love.

Name source Root source

Winnie

English: [WIN-ee]

Diminutive of Winifred, whose roots are disputed, possibly from Welsh Gwenfrewi. It is not securely defined by one simple meaning.

Someone whose friendly warmth makes others feel comfortable from the start.

Name source Root source

Willow

English: [WIL-oh]

English nature name from the tree, continuing Old English welig.

Someone who adapts with grace without losing their own sense of self.

Name source

Wilma

English: [WIL-muh]

Short form of Wilhelmina, feminine of Wilhelm, from Germanic will and protection elements.

Someone whose loyalty is steadfast and whose kindness is never forced.

Name source Root source

Whitney

English: [WIT-nee]

English surname from a place name, probably combining Old English white and island.

Someone whose open manner leaves plenty of room for a different way of being.

Name source

W 5 Boy Names for an English Storybook

MUSIC The Wind - Cat Stevens

Walter

British English: [WAWL-tuh]

From Germanic elements for power or authority and army.

Someone whose dependable nature makes it easier for others to feel brave.

Name source

William

English: [WIL-yuhm]

From Germanic Willehelm, combining will or desire with helmet or protection.

Someone who protects with care and trusts others to find their own strength.

Name source

Winston

English: [WIN-stuhn]

English surname from Wynnstan or a place associated with Wine. The deeper origin depends on the branch.

Someone whose optimism is steady and whose humour is gently reassuring.

Name source

Wilfred

English: [WIL-fruhd]

Old English name combining desire and peace.

Someone who values harmony while making sure every person's feelings matter.

Name source

Wesley

English: [WES-lee]

English place-derived surname combining west and a word for woodland or clearing.

Someone whose easy warmth helps friendship grow at its own pace.

Name source

X 5 Girl Names with a Fearless Spirit

MUSIC Runaway - AURORA

Xenia

Spanish: [SEH-nyah]

Greek xenia, hospitality, related to xenos, guest or stranger.

Someone whose welcome makes another person's differences feel valued.

Name source

Ximena

Spanish: [hee-MEH-nah]

Feminine of medieval Ximeno, of disputed origin: possibly Simon or Basque seme, son.

Someone who listens to understand and gives their own voice room to be heard.

Name source Root source

Xiomara

Spanish: [syoh-MAH-rah]

Possibly a Spanish form of Guiomar, itself perhaps from Germanic elements for battle and fame.

Someone whose fearless spirit is guided by a deeply compassionate heart.

Name source Root source

Xanthe

Classical Greek: [KSAN-theh]

From Greek xanthos, yellow or fair-haired, a name used in Greek mythology.

Someone whose bright individuality encourages others to embrace their own.

Name source

Xia

Mandarin: xià [SHYAH, falling tone] / xiá [SHYAH, rising tone]

Chinese romanization with several possible characters: 夏 can mean summer; 霞 refers to rosy clouds. Character and tone determine meaning.

Someone whose openness to change is matched by a gentle, hopeful heart.

Name source

X 5 Boy Names for a Globe-Trotting Story

MUSIC J'adore Venise - Loredana Bertè

Xavier

French: [gzah-VYEH]

From Basque Etxeberria, new house, originally a place name adopted through Saint Francis Xavier.

Someone who meets unfamiliar people with curiosity, warmth and respect.

Name source

Xander

British English: [ZAN-duh]

Short form of Alexander, from Greek elements for defend and men.

Someone whose courage makes others feel supported rather than overshadowed.

Name source Root source

Xavi

Catalan: [SHAH-bee]

Catalan diminutive of Xavier, ultimately from a Basque place name meaning new house.

Someone whose joyful confidence makes it easy for others to feel included.

Name source Root source

Xerxes

American English: [ZERK-seez]

Greek form of Old Persian Xshayarsha, traditionally interpreted as ruler over heroes.

Someone whose bold spirit is balanced by respect for another person's dignity.

Name source

Xenon

Ancient Greek [1]: [KSEH-non]

Greek personal name from xenos, guest or stranger; separate from the later chemical-element usage.

Someone who finds connection across differences without asking them to disappear.

Name source

Y 5 Girl Names for a Journey Around the World

MUSIC Merry-Go-Round of Life - Joe Hisaishi

Yara

Arabic: [YAH-rah]

In this Persian tradition, based on yar, friend or helper. Brazilian Yara has a separate Indigenous origin. Someone whose independent spirit carries a deep tenderness for others.

[Name source](#)

Yasmin

Arabic: [yahs-MEEN]

Arabic and Hebrew flower name borrowed from Persian yasamin, jasmine.

Someone whose affection is gentle and whose warmth reaches across differences.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#)

Yuna

International English approximation: [YOO-nah]

International name of uncertain formation, possibly from Japanese Yūna. Japanese meaning depends on the chosen kanji, with several combinations possible.

Someone whose thoughtful heart makes closeness feel calm and unforced.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#) [Pronunciation reference](#)

Ylva

Swedish approximation: [YL-vah]

Scandinavian name meaning female wolf, derived from Old Norse ulfr, wolf.

Someone who trusts their instincts and cares fiercely without holding too tightly.

[Name source](#) [Pronunciation reference](#)

Yvonne

French: [ee-VON]

French feminine form of Yvon, related to Yves and Germanic Ivo, probably from a word for yew.

Someone whose quiet resilience leaves room for gentleness and hope.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#)

Y 5 Boy Names with Stories from Everywhere

MUSIC Águas de Março - Elis Regina & Tom Jobim

Yusuf

Arabic: [YOO-suf]

Arabic form of Joseph, ultimately Hebrew Yosef, he will add.

Someone whose patience allows love and trust to grow in their own time.

Name source Root source

Yuri

Russian: [YOO-ree]

Here the Slavic form of George is used, from Greek words for earth and work, giving the sense farmer.

Someone whose grounded nature makes others feel at ease in an unfamiliar world.

Name source Root source

Yves

French: [EEV]

Medieval French form of Ivo, probably from a Germanic word for yew; a Celtic connection is also proposed.

Someone whose quiet charm comes from sincere interest in other people.

Name source Root source

Yannis

Greek: [YAH-nis]

Transcription of Greek Giannis, a form of John, ultimately Hebrew Yahweh is gracious.

Someone whose generous welcome makes a new connection feel wonderfully natural.

Name source Root source

Yasin

Arabic: [yah-SEEN]

Arabic name from the letter names ya and sin, which open the Quran's 36th surah. No settled literal phrase meaning is established.

Someone who is thoughtful about belonging and respectful of every person's story.

Name source

Z 5 Girl Names with a Spark of Mischief

MUSIC Le Festin - Camille

Zara

English: [ZAH-ruh]

English literary name, perhaps based on Zahra. Its later use has several influences, so bright is not a certain independent etymology.

Someone whose spirited confidence makes room for a soft, affectionate heart.

Name source Root source

Zahra

Arabic: [zah-RAH] (bright) / [ZAH-rah] (flower)

Two Arabic names share this spelling: one expresses brightness, another a blooming flower. They differ in Arabic writing and pronunciation.

Someone who helps others flourish by seeing what is already beautiful in them.

Name source Root source

Zoya

Russian: [ZOH-yah]

Slavic form of Greek Zoe, life.

Someone whose delight in life brings warmth to the people around them.

Name source Root source

Zelda

English: [ZEL-duh]

This English form shortens Griselda, perhaps from Germanic grey and battle; the origin is uncertain. Yiddish Zelda has a separate origin.

Someone whose imagination is fearless and whose loyalty is deeply felt.

Name source Root source

Zinnia

English: [ZIN-ee-ah]

From the flower, named after German botanist Johann Gottfried Zinn.

Someone whose playful individuality makes others feel free to be themselves.

Name source

Z 5 Boy Names for a Grand Entrance

MUSIC Love My Way - The Psychedelic Furs

Zayn

Arabic: [ZAYN]

Arabic name expressing beauty or grace.

Someone whose confidence is gentle and whose kindness makes a lasting impression.

[Name source](#)

Zeno

Italian: [DZEH-noh]

From Greek Zenon, derived from a form of the god-name Zeus.

Someone who thinks deeply while remaining open to what another person can teach them.

[Name source](#)

Zahir

Arabic: [dhah-HEER (voiced th)]

This Arabic form means helper or supporter. Other Arabic names transcribed Zahir can instead mean shining or apparent.

Someone whose wholehearted presence makes others feel truly acknowledged.

[Name source](#)

Zachary

English: [ZAK-uh-ree]

English form of Zechariah, from Hebrew elements for remember and Yahweh, interpreted as Yahweh remembers.

Someone whose care makes people feel remembered, even in the quietest moments.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#)

Zoran

Croatian: [ZOH-rahn]

Masculine form of South Slavic Zora, dawn.

Someone who welcomes new beginnings with hope and shares that hope generously.

[Name source](#) [Root source](#)

Format & delningsfrågor

UPPLÄGG: 7 BILDER

Bild 1: Illustrerad bokstav och engelsk omslagstitel.

Bild 2-6: Ett namn per bild. Använd story phrase, en kort etymologi och valt uttal.

Bild 7: En tydlig fråga och en uppmaning att skicka vidare.

HUVUDFRÅGA FÖR DELNING

Is your friend's name here? Send this to them - does the description fit?

ALTERNATIV

Which name feels most like someone you know? Send this to them.

Who would you cast in this story? Send this to your main character.

SECRET GARDEN

Which friend belongs in a story with an old library and a secret garden? Send this to them.

KOMMENTARER

Which name belongs in your story?

Know someone with one of these names? Does it suit them?

FORMAT ATT TESTA

Börja med fyra carousels med musik. Gör sedan en kort reel av ett tema som fått bra respons och jämför resultat. Välj en huvudfråga per inlägg.

Att veta före publicering

Titlarna fungerar tillsammans med den stora illustrerade bokstaven på omslaget. Varje grupp innehåller fem namn på den bokstaven; tjej och kille är redaktionella kategorier, inte en universell regel för hur namnet används.

Elodie behåller din stavning; den franska standardformen är Élodie. Ines har flera nationella stavningar, bland annat Inés och Inès. Här används den valda formen och ett uttal som hör till den.

Quilla: kopplingen till Quechua killa och Mama Quilla är belagd, men nutida bruk som personnamn och ett enhetligt internationellt namnuttal är mindre säkert. Uttalsraden visar grundordets Quechua-uttal.

Xia och Yuna: betydelse kan inte bestämmas från latinska bokstäver ensamma när namnet representerar olika kinesiska tecken eller japanska kanji. Välj en skriftform innan du publicerar en enda specifik betydelse.

Amara, Hana, Eira, Kira, Kian, Mira, Noa, Sami, Yara, Yuri och flera andra har skilda traditioner. Den valda etymologin här gäller den uttryckligen beskrivna grenen, inte alla som heter så.

Musiken är ett stämningsförslag. Kontrollera låtens tillgänglighet i ditt Instagramkonto när du publicerar. Publiceringsordningen är ett kreativt testupplägg, inte en empiriskt fastställd ranking.

Källorna öppnas genom de små länkarna på namnkorten. Huvudkälla: Behind the Name, med dess namnhistoriska referenser. Kompletteringar: ordboksuttal, användarinspelningar och uttalsguider samt uppslagsverk för Mama Quilla. Uppslagna 1 oktober 2026.